

Transportation Report



March 2026

INNOVATION: Technology Upgrade

The Transportation Department is actively implementing new onboard technology across the school bus fleet to improve communication, operational efficiency, and service to our families.

Key Updates:

- Tablets and mounting hardware have been received and installed on all buses.
- Strong parent interest in the *Stopfinder* pilot program, with 217 volunteers exceeding the initial goal of 100 participants. Approximately 160 students will actively participate in ridership scanning, with additional parents included in the app for expanded feedback.
- Staff training is underway in partnership with Transfinder and will continue through May.
- A phased rollout of the *Stopfinder* parent app will begin in mid-to-late April.

Priority Focus:

Implementation is being conducted with a strong emphasis on safety. Drivers are trained to ensure that use of onboard technology does not distract from critical responsibilities, including monitoring traffic and supervising students during loading and unloading. Safety remains the department's top priority throughout this transition.

TEAM BUILDING: Staffing & Retention

The department is preparing for multiple driver retirements at the end of the school year so we will start recruiting and interviewing candidates to fill some "big shoes".

Key Updates:

- Early hiring efforts are underway to ensure continuity of service.
- New drivers will ideally be onboarded in time to complete ride-alongs and route familiarization with retiring staff.
- While staffing has been very manageable over the past couple years, replacing excellence with excellence is certainly a big challenge.

Priority Focus:

Maintaining a high standard of personnel remains the foundation of the department's safety program. Emphasis continues on hiring and retaining dependable, student-focused drivers and mechanics.

v/r

Jeff Wolfe, Transportation Director